

SOIL CITY

Around a third of all creatures on the planet live in soil. Most rely on their fellow soil-dwellers for food. Some poo out nutrients for plants to eat. Scientists often group the animals together by size.

Plant root

Fungi and plants

Fungi release chemicals, called enzymes, which break down dead plants into nutrients. The fungi, as well as plants, can then absorb these nutrients to grow.

Hyphae are the skinny bits of fungi that absorb soil nutrients.

Springtails can spring (jump) as high as a pencil.

Earthworms

These wrigglers eat dead plants and make poo containing lots of nutrients. Soil organisms eat the poo to get the nutrients.

Moles burrow to

catch unsuspecting worms.

Moles

You may never see a worm-guzzling mole because it spends most of its life below ground. However, piles of freshly dug soil are a sign of moles beneath.